Hunor Portik

Senior Engineer | Distributed Systems

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PROFILE

Senior engineer with 7+ years building production backend and distributed systems in Python and Go. I seek product input first, then plan and build. Work spans stateless ETL, Kafka-backed event processing, and etcd-backed APIs; the production platform I support exceeds **250K events/sec on one cluster**. Experienced in production ownership, incident response, observability, and upstream Apache Beam contributions.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** Go (professional experience), Python (primary), SQL, Bash
- **Distributed systems & data:** Kafka, Pub/Sub, etcd, Apache Beam, Dataflow, Cloud Composer (Managed Airflow), GCS, Datastore (legacy), Cloud Bigtable, BigQuery, ClickHouse
- **Infrastructure:** GCP, Kubernetes, Terraform, Docker, GitLab CI/CD
- **Observability:** Prometheus, Grafana/PromQL, OpenTelemetry, StatsD, VictoriaMetrics, InfluxDB, Sentry, Pyroscope
- **Python:** Flask/FastAPI, Celery, Schematics, Pydantic
- **Open source:** Apache Beam and Go ecosystem contributions
- **Domain Knowledge**: Digital Marketing, Telco.

EXPERIENCE

Bloomreach — Senior Data Engineer (Contract)

2021 – Present · Remote

- **Technical owner of a critical Go ETL orchestrator:** led three engineers in iteratively hardening it from PoC to production while maintaining continuity; added monitoring, tooling, and automation, reducing maintenance from **3–5 hours/week to 1–2 days/year**, even under heavy load.
- **Hardened Go Kafka services for production:** migrated from Shopify Sarama to IBM Sarama, bounded retry buffers, made metadata refresh single-flight, and propagated OpenTelemetry trace context. Also built a Kafka-to-GCS operation-log exporter with retries and offset recovery.
- **Key contributor to a critical internal tracking API:** implemented in-cluster endpoints, bearer-token authentication, etcd-backed settings and routing, Kafka-backed event and batch commands, and automated tests; validated changes with Integration/QA under a near-zero-downtime requirement.

- **Led a tiered Cloud Composer rollout across ~7 clusters with two engineers.** When diagnostics revealed missing BigQuery data before release freeze, paused the rollout and restored affected environments to the prior scheduler; traced the issue to Apache Beam WRITE_TRUNCATE, added integration tests, and merged the upstream fix (PR #35558), enabling the rollout to resume.
- **Improved production observability** with Prometheus exporter metrics, corrected Grafana PromQL, StatsD instrumentation, and OpenTelemetry traces; partnered with SREs on observability requirements and used telemetry in L3/on-call investigations.
- **Handled hundreds of production incidents and support requests** in on-call rotations, including critical incidents with only two engineers available; stopped recurring production issues, preventing **tens of thousands of euros in further long-term costs**.
- **Independently built an isolated Go Kafka shadow-mirroring service** to compare candidate workers safely against production behavior; documented repeatable evaluation and teardown workflows and transferred them to the team.
- **Implemented key parts of the initial Go Kafka-to-ClickHouse ingestion service,** including context-aware consumption, batching, schema-based writes, malformed-record handling, integration tests, and throughput/latency metrics.

Ericsson — Software Developer / DevOps

2019 – 2021

- **Reduced product installation time from several weeks to about three hours** by automating end-to-end deployment with Ansible and Jenkins.
- Built a Python dependency-reporting tool that replaced several days of manual work per release cycle; also developed containerized Spring services and improved Jenkins CI pipelines.

Earlier Experience

- **Ericsson — Software Developer Intern, Summer 2018:** Built a Python tool for processing H.264 codec data.
- **Accenture and Lynx Solutions — Software Developer Intern, Feb 2017 – Aug 2017:** Developed mobile and web applications using C# and Swift.

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science, Sapientia — Hungarian University of Transylvania

2015 - 2018

Thesis: Engineered a robust ETL and NLP system for local press-monitoring and textual coherence analysis using NLTK and statistical visualization.

LANGUAGES

- Native Hungarian | Fluent English | Beginner Spanish & Romanian.